

Daily Market Summary

July 20, 2026

Market Tone — Today's Session

A recap of how the market traded today — not a forecast.

Today: -0.14 → Slightly Bearish

Trend (5-day EMA): -0.14 → Slightly Bearish — smoothed, the readable day-over-day signal.

Component	Weight	Score
Market data	70%	-0.16
News headlines	20%	-0.16
Reddit (disabled)	0%	+0.04
Fed (rate expectations)	10%	+0.01

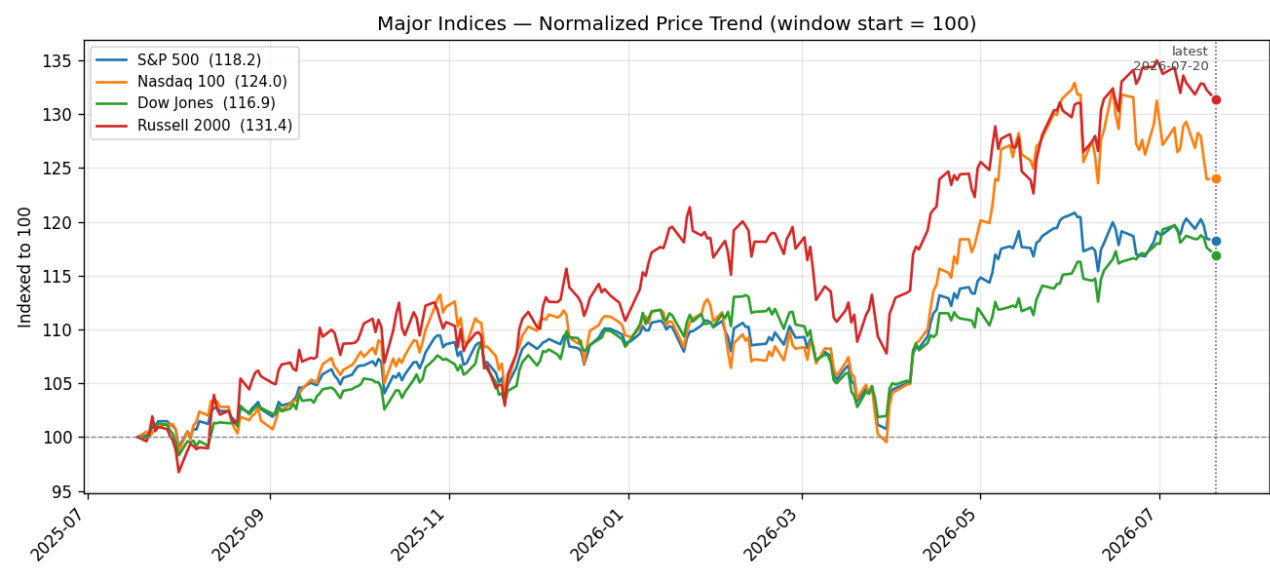
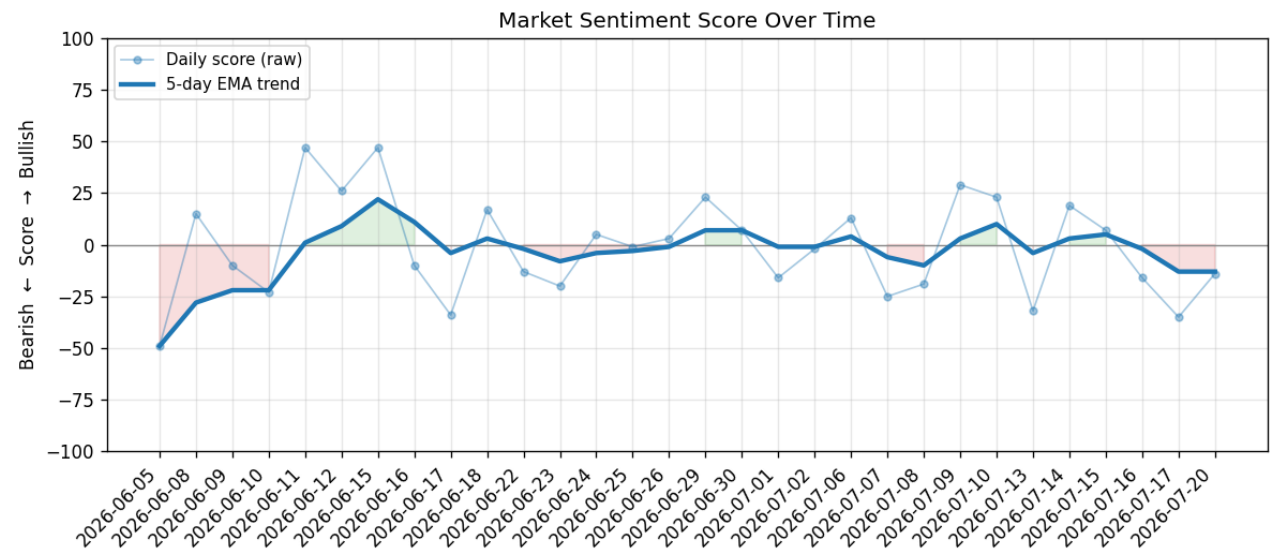
Equities fell with Nasdaq +0.0%, S&P 500 -0.2%, VIX -0.6%. Sector breadth: 3/11 sectors up. 10Y yield +1.3%. News headlines read slightly bearish. Fed-policy expectations held steady. Today's overall market tone: Slightly Bearish. (news scored with finbert)

Standout headlines

Most bullish (+0.87) — Best high-yield savings interest rates today, Monday, July 20, 2026: Earn up to 4.10% APY

Most bearish (-0.94) — Amazon closes another major facility, nearly 500 workers affected

Trend Charts



Sector Watch (AI Stack)

Score describes the day: driven by the session move (70%), with breadth (avg % of the 20/50-day MAs the basket trades above, 15%) and news (15%) for texture. Relative strength (vs the Nasdaq for tech baskets, the S&P for the rest) is shown as a context column but doesn't drive the label. Sorted strongest→weakest.

Sector	Move	Rel. Str.	Breadth	News	Overall
SaaS	+1.77%	+1.73% vs Nasdaq	89%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.74)
Networking / Interconnect	+1.98%	+1.94% vs Nasdaq	14%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.63)
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	+2.04%	+2.00% vs Nasdaq	0%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.58)
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	+1.12%	+1.08% vs Nasdaq	36%	Neutral	Bullish (+0.42)
Semiconductors / Compute	+0.95%	+0.91% vs Nasdaq	15%	Slightly Bullish	Bullish (+0.33)
Banking	-1.02%	-0.83% vs S&P	75%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.35)
Consumer	-0.65%	-0.46% vs S&P	38%	Neutral	Bearish (-0.37)
Pharma / Healthcare	-1.14%	-0.95% vs S&P	75%	Slightly Bullish	Bearish (-0.38)

Positioning & Regime

Was today bullish or bearish, read through positioning: out-of-the-money put/call volume (hedging vs chasing, daily) and short %-of-float (squeeze fuel; exchange data, biweekly) explain the character of the day's move — squeeze rebound, hedged advance, conviction selling. **Under evaluation** — logged daily, drives no scores.

Basket	OTM P/C	Short Flt	Day	Today's Read
Banking	0.80	0.0%	-1.02%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Pharma / Healthcare	0.73	1.7%	-1.13%	Bearish — orderly decline; positioning unremarkable
Networking / Interconnect	0.62	4.3%	+1.98%	Bullish — short-squeeze rebound — shorts/puts were loaded into the selloff and fueled the rip
Hyperscalers & Neoclouds	0.53	1.6%	+1.12%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Memory (DRAM/NAND/HBM)	0.51	5.3%	+2.04%	Bullish — short-squeeze rebound — shorts/puts were loaded into the selloff and fueled the rip

SaaS	0.49	5.5%	+1.77%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
Consumer	0.42	1.9%	-0.65%	Bearish — decline without hedging demand — flows not panicked
Semiconductors / Compute	0.24	2.5%	+0.95%	Bullish — broad advance; positioning unremarkable
All tracked	0.38	2.4%	-0.03%	Neutral — quiet session

Top Gainers

Company	Price	% Change
Archer Aviation Inc. (ACHR)	5.31	+19.59%
IREN LIMITED (IREN)	40.20	+19.57%
Cipher Digital Inc. (CIFR)	20.54	+16.97%
X-Energy, Inc. (XE)	15.66	+11.70%
CleanSpark, Inc. (CLSK)	14.42	+10.67%

Top News

Amazon closes another major facility, nearly 500 workers affected — Yahoo Finance

Global oil prices settle at one-month high despite new Iran ceasefire proposal, as blockade on Saudi Arabia by Yemen’s Houthis keeps market on edge — MarketWatch (Top)

Oil prices settled at one-month highs in volatile trading on Monday as traders weighed escalating geopolitical tensions following a fresh barrage of strikes across the Middle East over the weekend against reports of a new ceasefire proposal between the U.S. and Iran.

Stocks making the biggest moves midday: AMD, Archer Aviation, SpaceX, Iren & more — CNBC (Finance)

These are the stocks posting the largest moves in midday trading.

Tutor Perini and V2X shares rise on S&P SmallCap 600 inclusion — Investing.com

Daily Spotlight: Three Signals from Dividend Growth — Yahoo Finance

Market Snapshot

Major Indices

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
S&P 500	7,443.28	-14.41	-0.19%
Nasdaq 100	28,604.23	+11.58	+0.04%
Dow Jones	51,839.26	-307.16	-0.59%
Russell 2000	2,942.43	-19.79	-0.67%
VIX	18.65	-0.12	-0.64%

Key Stocks

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Nvidia	203.28	+0.47	+0.23%
Microsoft	402.29	+8.47	+2.15%
AMD	503.57	+7.81	+1.58%
Meta	645.85	-0.16	-0.02%
Alphabet	351.37	+5.25	+1.52%
Broadcom	378.16	+7.33	+1.98%
Micron	865.46	+16.51	+1.94%
Intel	97.06	+2.02	+2.13%
SanDisk	1,390.95	+36.13	+2.67%
Coherent	285.40	+7.80	+2.81%
Amazon	249.99	+2.76	+1.12%
Apple	326.59	-7.15	-2.14%
Arm	269.61	+2.42	+0.91%

Commodities & Crypto

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
Gold	4,011.80	-7.00	-0.17%
Crude Oil	82.42	+0.64	+0.78%
Bitcoin	65,294.73	+922.12	+1.43%

FX Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
EUR/USD	1.14	-0.00	-0.25%
USD/JPY	162.49	+0.14	+0.08%
GBP/USD	1.34	-0.00	-0.21%

Interest Rates

Instrument	Price	Change	% Change
10Y Treasury Yield	4.60	+0.06	+1.26%
13-Week T-Bill Yield	3.71	-0.00	-0.05%

Analyst Summary

Market Overview

U.S. equity markets delivered a mixed session on July 20, with the Nasdaq 100 edging up 0.04% while the S&P 500 and Dow Jones slipped 0.19% and 0.59%, respectively. The Russell 2000 underperformed with a 0.67% decline, underscoring a distinct rotation into large-cap technology and away from economically sensitive sectors. The VIX fell slightly to 18.65, suggesting complacency despite modest headline weakness.

Technology and AI Leadership

A clear tech divide emerged, with the AI ecosystem delivering robust gains while broader cyclicals lagged. The Memory sector led with a 2.04% surge, exhibiting classic short-squeeze dynamics—positioning data revealed 5.3% short float and elevated put activity that likely fueled the rally. SanDisk surged 2.67% and Micron jumped 1.94%, while Coherent gained 2.81%. Networking/Interconnect stocks rose 1.98%, similarly driven by short covering (4.3% short float, 0.62 put/call ratio).

Microsoft stood out among mega-caps with a 2.15% gain, accompanied by strong performances from Intel (+2.13%), Broadcom (+1.98%), and Alphabet (+1.52%). The SaaS sector climbed 1.77% on broad participation (89% breadth). Notably, Apple declined 2.14%, representing a rare divergence within Big Tech. The sector rotation appears driven by anticipation of upcoming earnings, particularly Alphabet's Wednesday report, which traders expect could showcase record revenue amid AI infrastructure buildout.

Standout Gainers and Energy Themes

Among the market's top gainers, Archer Aviation and IREN LIMITED each surged nearly 20%, while crypto miners Cipher Digital (+16.97%) and CleanSpark (+10.67%) rallied in tandem with Bitcoin's 1.43% advance. X-Energy climbed 11.70%, reflecting ongoing interest in nuclear power for AI data center infrastructure—a theme reinforced by Hut 8's announcement of a \$9.8 billion AI data center lease.

Crude oil rose 0.78% to \$82.42, touching a one-month high amid reports of Houthi blockades affecting Saudi Arabia and heightened Middle East tensions despite Iran ceasefire proposals. Social media chatter flagged dwindling U.S. supply—reportedly just 43 days remaining—adding to bullish sentiment.

Rates, FX, and Defensives Under Pressure

The 10-year Treasury yield climbed 6 basis points to 4.60%, weighing on rate-sensitive sectors. Banking, Consumer, and Pharma/Healthcare all declined over 1%, showing orderly selling without hedging panic (low put/call ratios). The dollar edged higher against the euro and pound, while USD/JPY ticked up to 162.49. Gold dipped modestly to \$4,011.80.

The session reflected a classic "stay long innovation, fade defensives" positioning ahead of key tech earnings and amid ongoing geopolitical oil supply concerns.